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Ocean sunsets. Room to live well.

Perth is Australia's sunniest capital: a relaxed river city on the Indian Ocean, with white-sand beaches, short commutes and a health system that has welcomed overseas clinicians for decades. It is the city people dismiss on the map and then fall for in person, and for many families it becomes the place where life finally has room to breathe.

~2.3M

people in Greater Perth

~3,000

hours of sunshine a year

~19

metropolitan beaches

~30 min

by ferry to Rottnest Island

IN THIS GUIDE

01 Why clinicians choose Perth

02 A sunny city between the ocean and the hills

03 Healthcare and work in Perth

04 Where to live in Perth

05 Getting around Perth

06 What it costs to live here

07 Sophie's insights

08 Food, shopping and everyday life

09 What people do at the weekend

10 Around Perth

11 Families and schools in Perth

12 Local directory

13 Useful contacts

14 Your Ethicare journey

Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose Perth

Clinicians usually come to Perth for the lifestyle and the career, and stay because the two fit together so easily: a good job, a short drive, and the beach before dinner.



If you're looking for big-city buzz and a weekend in another capital every month, Perth may not be it. But if you're drawn to sunshine, uncrowded beaches, short commutes and a health service that knows how to welcome you, Perth could be a wonderful choice.

Start with daily life, because that is what wins people over. Perth's beaches are among the most beautiful of any Australian capital: white sand, clear water and a sunset over the ocean, and rarely crowded. It is the sunniest capital in the country, commutes are short, and a family home within twenty minutes or so of a tertiary campus is a realistic plan rather than a dream.

Professionally, Western Australia runs a genuine tertiary system with many newer facilities than the eastern states, and it has recruited internationally for decades. That means the process is well practised, orientation for overseas-trained staff is routine, and relocation support is common rather than exceptional.

A typical week might look like this: a twenty-minute drive or a train to work, a swim at Cottesloe or Trigg before a late start, coffee in Leederville or Mount Lawley, and Friday evening watching the sun drop into the Indian Ocean, which locals still stop for. Saturday is Fremantle's markets or the ferry to Rottnest with the bikes; Sunday is the Swan Valley among the vines, twenty-five minutes from the city.

WHAT YOU GAIN

A beach life, every day

Nineteen metropolitan beaches and warm, clear water for much of the year. A swim before work is an ordinary thing here.

Time back

Wide roads, fast rail lines and short commutes. Most clinicians are home in time for the evening, with daylight to spare.

A system used to welcoming you

Decades of international recruitment mean well-worn pathways, orientation and support for overseas-trained staff.

A regional migration advantage

The whole of Western Australia, Perth included, is currently classed as regional for skilled migration, which can open pathways the big eastern capitals do not. Ask us how this applies to you.

GOOD TO KNOW

A long way from everywhere

The east coast is around four to five hours by air, and long-haul travel is part of life. It suits you best if your life travels with you; plan your trips home into the year from the start.

A smaller market

A strong tertiary system, with fewer sites than Sydney or Melbourne. If your field is very specialised, talk to us early about where you would fit.

Long, warm summers

Months of dry sunshine, softened on the coast by the afternoon sea breeze. A home with good cooling and shade makes all the difference.

A relaxed pace

Perth is outdoorsy and easygoing rather than dense and urban. If you love that, you will feel at home quickly.

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An honest word before you decide

Perth is one of the most sought-after destinations in Australia, and competition for healthcare roles here is very high. Securing a role, and particularly a sponsored role, is considerably more challenging in Perth than in regional Australia. Perth's regional status for migration can widen your visa options, but it does not change how many people are applying for each role. We are not saying it's impossible, but we want to be honest with you: it can take longer, and it helps to be flexible. Many clinicians start in a regional city, where demand and sponsorship are often stronger, and move to Perth later with Australian experience behind them.

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Same clock as Asia

Perth runs on Western Standard Time (UTC+8) with no daylight saving: two hours behind Sydney in winter and three in summer, and the same clock as Singapore and Hong Kong. Direct flights to South-East Asia take around five hours, and there are direct services to Europe, so for families in Asia, Africa or the UK the flight map from Perth is often better than you might expect.



The city at blue hour from Kings Park, the 400-hectare park on the escarpment above the centre



Heritage streets and pavement cafés in Fremantle, the port city at the mouth of the Swan



Parliament House on the hill above the city, with its gardens in bloom



A morning surf before a late shift is an ordinary pleasure on this coast



Weekend brunch outdoors, for most of the year



Wildlife is part of life in Western Australia, from kangaroos to dolphins and quokkas

A sunny city between the ocean and the hills

Perth is wonderfully simple to read: a long, narrow city on a coastal plain, with the Indian Ocean on one side, the Swan River through the middle and the Darling Scarp rising behind.

Around 2.3 million people live in Greater Perth, Australia's fourth-largest city and the capital of its largest state. The Swan River widens through the middle of the city; the central business district sits on its northern bank, with Kings Park on the escarpment above, and South Perth looks back across the water. Elizabeth Quay and the foreshore have reconnected the centre to the river, and the main tertiary campuses sit close in, on both sides of it.

North and south of the river mouth, the beach suburbs run for around a hundred kilometres: Cottesloe, City Beach, Scarborough and Trigg in the middle, Hillarys and Sorrento further north, and Fremantle at the river mouth with its port, heritage buildings and an identity all of its own. Inland, the plain runs flat for about twenty kilometres before rising into the Perth Hills at Kalamunda and Mundaring, cooler, greener and semi-rural, with the Swan Valley's vineyards to the north-east.

The city grew late and fast, so much of the housing, transport and infrastructure is newer than in the eastern capitals. It is also strongly international: around a third of residents were born overseas, with large British, Irish and South African communities, and well-established Indian, Malaysian, Singaporean, Filipino and Vietnamese families.



Elizabeth Quay, where the city centre meets the Swan River

Summer

DEC – FEB

Long, dry and sunny, often in the low thirties and sometimes hotter. The afternoon sea breeze, the 'Fremantle Doctor', cools the coast most days. Beach season, and bushfire season, so follow the official warnings.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Many locals' favourite months: warm sea, settled weather and golden evenings. Perfect for Rottnest, the river and weekends down south.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Short, mild and green, with most of the year's rain. Days are usually in the high teens; a jacket rather than a coat, and waterfalls running in the hills.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Warming up, and wildflower season: Western Australia's bush blooms with thousands of species, many found nowhere else on earth.



A note on Country

Perth stands on Whadjuk Noongar boodja, part of Noongar Country, which covers the whole south-west of the state. Boorloo is the Noongar name for the Perth area, and Derbarl Yerrigan for the Swan River. The Noongar calendar has six seasons (Birak, Bunuru, Djeran, Makuru, Djilba and Kambarang), and you will see it used in schools, parks and health services. Acknowledgement of Country opens many meetings, and your cultural induction is a lovely place to start learning.

LOCAL WORD

The Doctor

The Fremantle Doctor: the cooling afternoon sea breeze that rescues a summer day.

LOCAL WORD

Freo

Fremantle, the port city at the river mouth, with markets, music and a strong character.

LOCAL WORD

Rotto

Rottnest Island (Wadjemup): bikes, quokkas, no cars, and half an hour by ferry.

LOCAL CUSTOM

Sundowner

A drink at sunset, usually facing the ocean. Perth's sun sets over the water, and the city makes the most of it.

Healthcare and work in Perth

Perth offers a genuine tertiary system in a city small enough to get to know, with many newer facilities and a long history of welcoming overseas-trained clinicians.

Western Australia runs its public system through a small number of health services, each an employer in its own right. Several cover metropolitan Perth, broadly the north, the south and the east, and each anchors a tertiary teaching campus with secondary and community sites around it. Alongside them sit a statewide children's service, a single country service covering the vast regional and remote state, and a substantial private sector in hospitals, imaging and pathology.

Aboriginal community-controlled health organisations play an important role in both the city and the regions, and cultural safety training is part of working here. Registration is national through Ahpra, so the same registration lets you work anywhere in Australia.



Perth's health services have recruited internationally for decades, so you will often work alongside other overseas-trained colleagues

Newer

facilities

Several major campuses built or rebuilt in recent years

Decades

of international recruitment

Orientation and support are well practised

Regional

for skilled migration

The whole state, Perth included

What that means for your career is a system you can know personally. You will meet the people who lead your specialty in the state within a year or so, and opportunities often come through relationships faster than in a bigger city. If your field is very specialised, there may be only a handful of possible employers, so it is worth talking to us early about where you would fit best.

Beyond the city, the regional and remote work is unlike anything on the east coast: the Pilbara, the Kimberley, the Goldfields and the South West, often with broad scope and attractive incentives. Some Perth roles include rotations to country sites, which many clinicians come to love.

NORTH, SOUTH AND EAST

Tertiary teaching campuses

Each metropolitan service anchors a major campus with the full range of specialties, trauma, research and training.

STATEWIDE

Children's health

A dedicated statewide service for children and young people, with a modern tertiary children's hospital at its heart.

THE WHOLE REGIONAL STATE

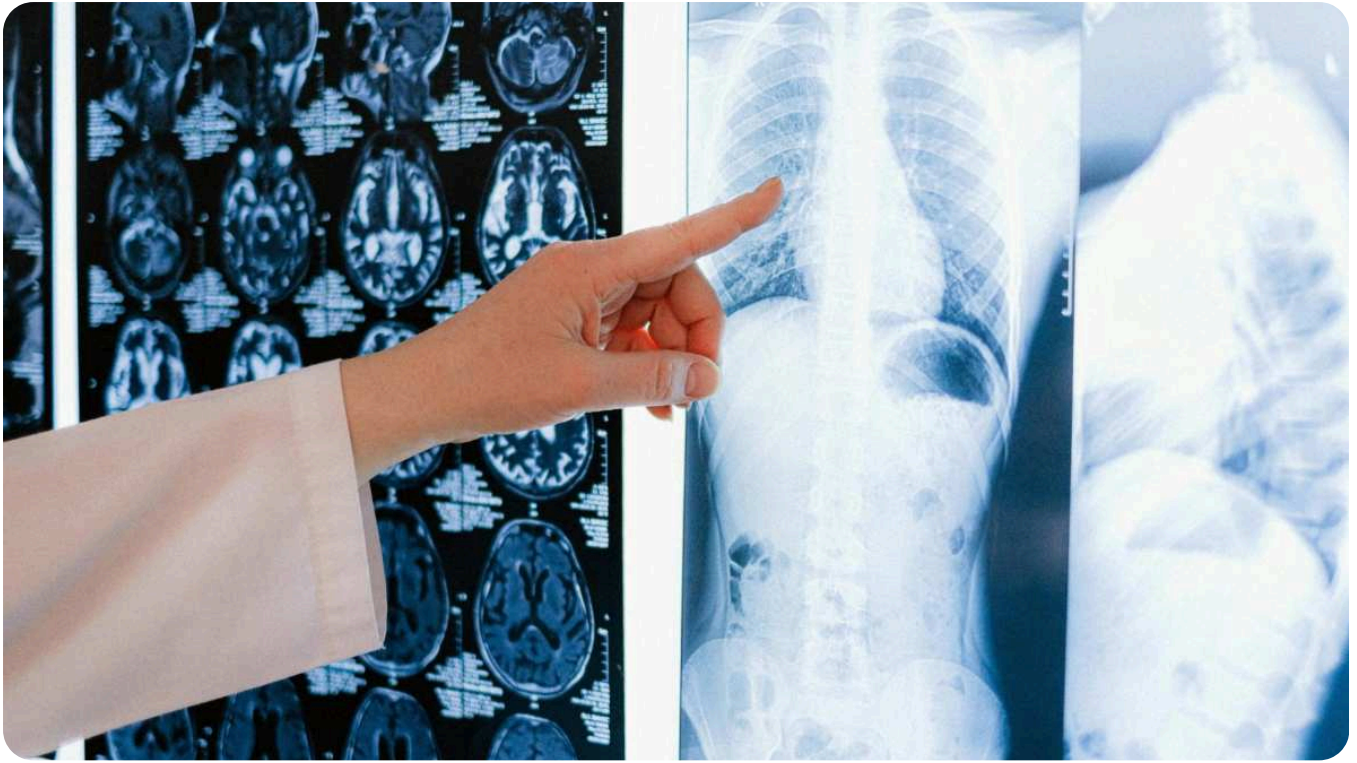
Country health

One service covering one of the largest health service areas in the world by geography, from Esperance to the Kimberley.

ACROSS THE METRO AREA

Private and community

Private hospitals, a large imaging and pathology market, general practice and Aboriginal community-controlled health services.



Imaging and allied health roles span the public campuses and a large private sector

Giving yourself the best chance in Perth

- ✓ Be open to more than one campus, service or shift pattern. The wider your search, the better your chances.
- ✓ Keep a regional option alongside Perth. Regional cities often have stronger demand and are more able to sponsor, and Australian experience makes a later move to Perth much easier.
- ✓ Get your registration well under way early. Employers here often favour candidates who can start sooner.
- ✓ Talk to us early, so we can give you a realistic picture for your profession and specialty.

What to ask at interview

- ☐ Pay follows WA awards and enterprise agreements. We quote no figures here and will walk you through the current agreement for your profession.
- ☐ Salary packaging: public-health roles can package part of your pay before tax, so ask how much and how to start it from day one.
- ☐ Which health service and which campus, and whether you may be rostered across sites.
- ☐ The roster: shift patterns, penalties, on-call frequency and how gaps are covered.
- ☐ Relocation support, which is common here and well worth asking about.
- ☐ CPD: funded time and budget, and whether travel to east-coast conferences is covered.
- ☐ Supervision and support in your first year, especially if you trained overseas.
- ☐ Any rural or regional rotations, and the allowances that come with them.



Two things to do early

Start your Ahpra registration as soon as Perth is on your shortlist, because paperwork is usually what sets your start date. And ask about the regional migration position explicitly: it is a real advantage, and worth understanding before you compare offers.



Teams are used to welcoming colleagues from overseas, from the first week of orientation



Theatre teams across the metropolitan campuses



Patient-centred care, wherever in the system you work

Where to live in Perth

Perth's housing choice comes down to a lovely question: how close to the ocean would you like to be? Coast, river, character suburbs or the hills, each has its own feel, and most are a short drive from work.

~15–20 MIN · BEACHES

Cottesloe, Swanbourne & City Beach

The classic western-suburbs coast: white sand at the end of the street, the sea breeze first and a sundowner on the sand. Premium, and wonderful.

~20–25 MIN · SURF & FAMILY

Scarborough, Trigg & Sorrento

The same beautiful coast, more family-shaped and better value as you head north, with surf clubs, newer homes and the Scarborough foreshore.

~10–15 MIN · RIVER & SCHOOLS

Nedlands, Claremont & Subiaco

Leafy, established suburbs near the river and the central campuses, with well-regarded schools and character homes.

~10–20 MIN · RIVER VIEWS

South Perth, Como & Applecross

Riverside living south of the water: foreshore paths, established trees, the ferry into town and easy access to the southern campuses.

~10 MIN · CAFÉS & CHARACTER

Mount Lawley, Leederville & North Perth

1920s bungalows, café strips and small bars: the closest Perth comes to inner-city living, and very walkable.

~25 MIN · PORT CITY

Fremantle & around

South Fremantle, Beaconsfield and White Gum Valley: limestone heritage, markets, arts and a strong community, close to the southern campuses.

30–40 MIN · SPACE & TREES

Kalamunda & the Perth Hills

Semi-rural life with cooler air, big gardens and bushwalks. Lovely for families who want space; plan ahead for the bushfire season.

TRAIN-SERVED · BEST VALUE

The rail corridors, north & south

Newer suburbs along the northern and southern rail lines, from Joondalup to Baldivis, with the newest and most affordable family homes.

Many clinicians rent for six months to a year while they learn the city, then choose a suburb for good. A family house within about twenty minutes of a tertiary campus is a realistic plan in Perth, which is true of very few Australian cities. Rents move with the resources economy, so ask locals and your new colleagues what the market has been doing lately.



A federation-era character home in Subiaco, ten minutes from the city



And what the back garden of one can look like: outdoor living for most of the year



Cottesloe Beach, the western suburbs' favourite stretch of sand

Before you sign a lease

- ☐ How far inland is it, and does the afternoon sea breeze reach? It can be worth several degrees on a summer afternoon.
- ☐ What is the commute to your campus, and is there a train line nearby?
- ☐ Cooling: what kind of air conditioning is there, and how does the home handle a run of hot days?
- ☐ In the hills or on the bushland fringe: what is the bushfire rating, and what is the plan?
- ☐ Is it in the local-intake area for the school you want? Public school places are linked to your address.

Getting around Perth

Perth is one of the easiest Australian capitals to get around: fast rail lines, wide roads, short commutes, and flat, sunny streets made for cycling.

Public transport is run by Transperth, and one tap-on card, SmartRider, covers trains, buses and ferries (contactless bank cards also work). Fast rail lines run north, south and east along the freeways to the growth suburbs, plus the Fremantle line and the Airport line. Free CAT buses loop through the city centre, Fremantle and Joondalup, and the ferry crosses the river to South Perth.

Outside the train corridors, Perth is a car city, but an easy one: wide roads, light traffic by east-coast standards and parking at a fraction of Sydney's cost. Australians drive on the left. The flat terrain and sunshine also make Perth one of Australia's best cycling cities, with separated paths along the river, the coast and the rail lines.



Fremantle station, the end of the line from the city: about half an hour by train

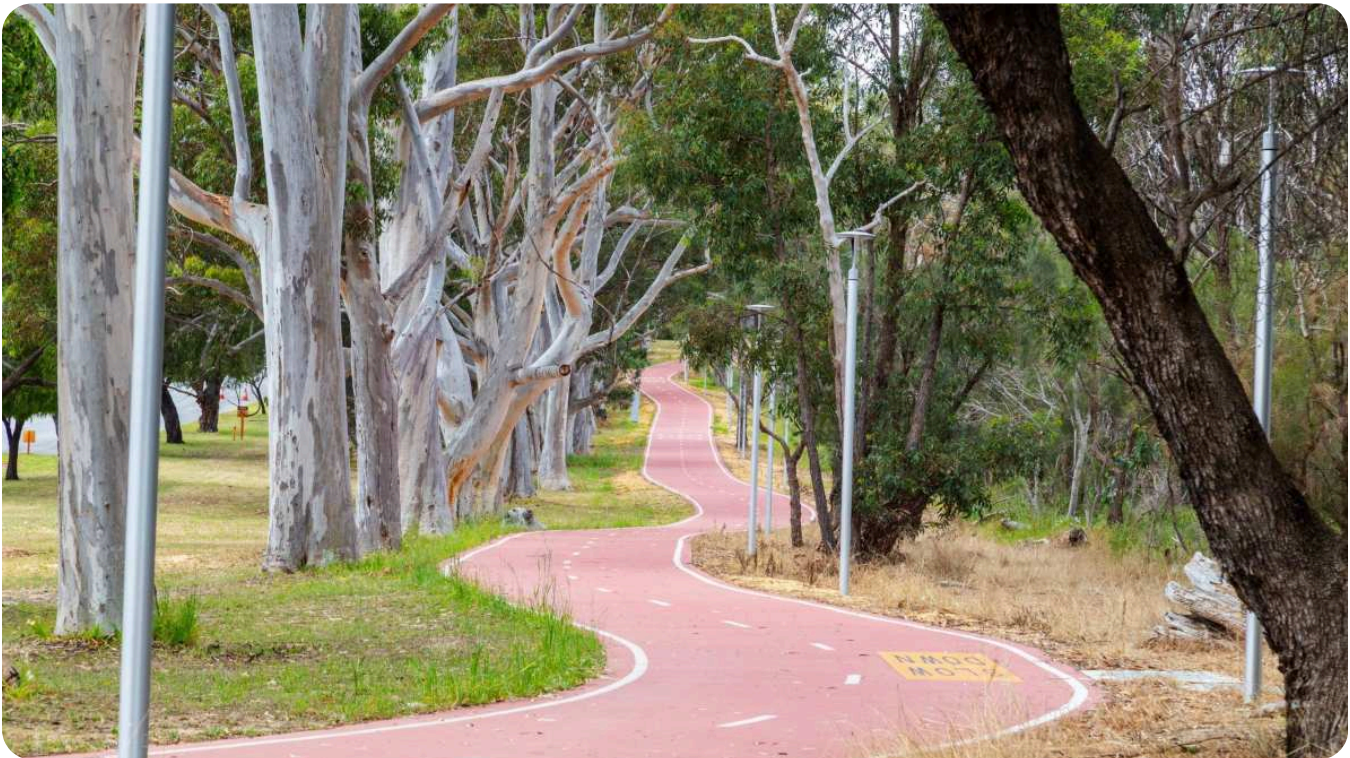
FROM THE CITY CENTRE TO	ROUGHLY	HOW
Cottesloe & City Beach	15–20 min	Drive, or train and bus
Scarborough & Trigg	~20 min	Drive or bus
Fremantle	~25–30 min	Train

FROM THE CITY CENTRE TO	ROUGHLY	HOW
Perth Airport	~20 min	Train or drive
Swan Valley	~25 min	Drive
Perth Hills (Kalamunda)	30–40 min	Drive
Mandurah	~50 min	Train or drive
Rottnest Island	~30 min from Fremantle	Ferry



Driving licences

Licence conversion is handled by the WA Department of Transport. Licences from many countries can be converted without a driving test, so check their 'moving to WA' guidance soon after you arrive, as there is a time limit for driving on an overseas licence once you live here. Outside the city, distances are large: plan fuel stops and take care with wildlife around dawn and dusk.



Shared paths under the gums: Perth's flat terrain makes cycling a real option for the commute

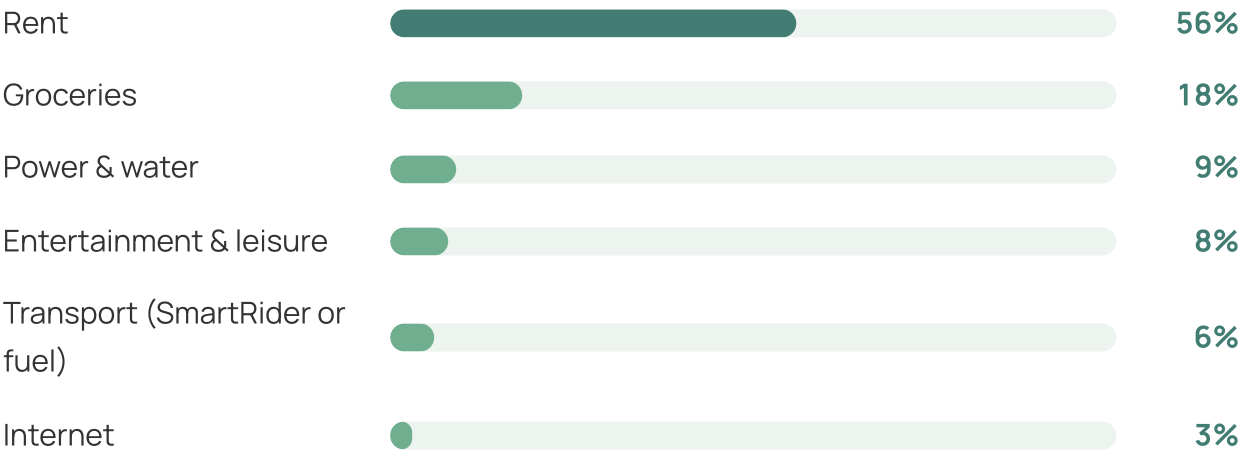
What it costs to live here

Perth sits comfortably below Sydney and Melbourne on housing, close to Brisbane, and its best pleasures, the beaches, the parks and the sunsets, cost nothing at all.

We don't print prices in our guides, because a figure that was right when it was written can mislead a year later. What stays true is the shape of a month and which lines are worth planning for. For today's numbers, use the comparison links in the local directory and compare Perth with the city you are leaving.

The structural point is a happy one: a family home within about twenty minutes of a tertiary campus is a realistic plan here. Shorter commutes mean less fuel and more of your day, there are effectively no toll roads in the state, and public-health roles can salary-package part of your pay before tax.

Where a month goes



Proportions for one person on a mid-range budget, not amounts. Rent is the biggest line, and in Perth it takes a noticeably smaller share than in Sydney or Melbourne.

Worth planning for

- ✓ Trips home. Perth is a long way from family overseas and on the east coast, so most people build two or three trips a year into their budget from the start.
- ✓ Some imported groceries cost a little more, while local produce, seafood and fruit are excellent and well priced.
- ✓ Summer cooling. A shaded home that gets the sea breeze does a lot of the work for free; further inland, air conditioning works harder.
- ✓ The setting-up period: temporary accommodation, a bond of up to four weeks' rent plus rent in advance, and a car.



The best of Perth is free: nineteen metropolitan beaches, surf lessons and long summer evenings



Beach days, river paths and park barbecues cost nothing, which is why weekends here go so far

IN SHORT

- ✓ Housing is clearly more affordable than in Sydney or Melbourne, and short commutes give you time as well as money back.
- ✓ Build flights home into your yearly plan; it is the one line that is uniquely Perth.
- ✓ Choose a home with shade, good cooling and the sea breeze if you can, and enjoy everything that is free.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

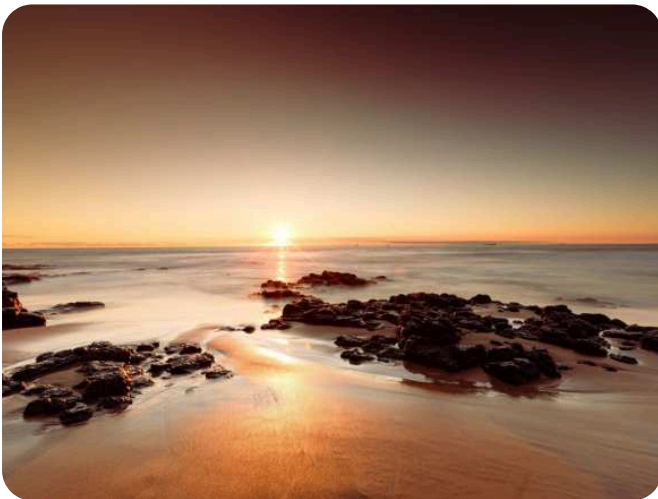
What I tell people about Perth

Perth is the city candidates often dismiss on the map and then fall in love with in person. The beaches, the sunshine and the space for family life are some of the best in Australia, and the health service is genuinely good at welcoming international staff, because it has been doing it for decades.

The question I always ask is about family. If you need to reach people at home quickly, we will plan your year around trips back together, and the direct flights to Asia and Europe help more than people expect. If your life travels with you, Perth is one of the most beautiful places in Australia to build it, and I love watching families settle here.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Sunset on the beach at Bunbury, two hours south of Perth: in WA the sun sets over the sea



Camping weekends are a national habit

Food, shopping and everyday life

Perth's food scene surprises people: superb local seafood, a strong South-East Asian influence, wine country twenty-five minutes away, and most of it enjoyed outdoors at sunset.



Western rock lobster, landed off the WA coast: local seafood is one of the great everyday pleasures here

FRI-SUN · FREMANTLE

Fremantle Markets

A Victorian market hall with produce, makers, street food and buskers. A Perth institution since 1897.

NEXT TO THE CITY CENTRE

Northbridge

The city's Asian food quarter, Vietnamese, Malaysian, Chinese, Japanese and Korean, plus many of the small bars.

~ 25 MIN

The Swan Valley

Cellar doors, breweries, chocolate and farm produce: the shortest trip to wine country of any Australian capital.

LOCAL AND FRESH

Seafood

Rock lobster, snapper, dhufish and prawns. Fish and chips at the Fremantle fishing boat harbour is the classic first weekend.

For the weekly shop you will find Woolworths, Coles, ALDI and IGA everywhere, plus WA's own independent grocers and farmers' markets. Perth's migration history means flavours of home are easy to find: halal butchers, Asian supermarkets, Indian grocers, South African stores and British import shops, especially around Northbridge, Cannington, Morley, Mirrabooka and Willetton. Our local directory lists some to start with.

Life here is lived outdoors and early: a swim before work, coffee after, free gas barbecues in the foreshore parks and dinner outside for most of the year. The calendar runs on the Perth Festival and Fringe World in summer, Sculpture by the Sea at Cottesloe, and Australian rules football, which is close to a civic religion. Clubs, places of worship and community associations sit alongside the shops, and they help a new city feel like home quickly, especially if you are arriving from the UK, South Africa, India or the Philippines.



Perth shares a time zone with South-East Asia, and its food shows it



Café culture is part of the daily rhythm, from Leederville to Fremantle



London Court, the Tudor-style arcade in the heart of the city's shopping streets

Everyday Perth, in one list

- ✓ Fremantle Markets at the weekend; growers' markets for the serious shop.
- ✓ Buy the local seafood: it is some of the best fresh food in the country.
- ✓ Northbridge for Asian food and small bars; the Swan Valley for a Sunday.
- ✓ Learn the word sundowner, and find your nearest west-facing beach.



Long lunches with friends, often outdoors and often with a view of the water



Indian and Sri Lankan groceries and restaurants are easy to find across Perth



Brunch culture, from Leederville to Fremantle

What people do at the weekend

Perth's weekends are wonderfully good and wonderfully close: an island half an hour by ferry, nineteen beaches inside the city, and wine country twenty-five minutes away.

Weekends here revolve around the water. Cottesloe is for the sunset crowd, Scarborough for the surf and the beach pool, Trigg for the waves, Mettams Pool for snorkelling over the reef and City Beach for families. The Swan River is the city's other playground: kayaking, sailing, paddleboarding and the foreshore paths, with Kings Park above it all for picnics, playgrounds and the best view in town.

Rottne Island, Wadjemup, is so close that Perth families treat it as part of the city: no cars, just bikes, more than sixty beaches and the famously cheerful quokkas. Inland, the Perth Hills offer bushwalks, winter waterfalls and villages that stay cooler in summer.

~30 MIN FERRY FROM FREMANTLE

Rottne by bike

Hire bikes off the ferry and have a bay to yourself by mid-morning. Snorkel, swim and say hello to the quokkas.

~20 MIN

Mettams Pool & Trigg

Calm reef snorkelling in a sheltered pool, then breakfast by the beach at Trigg.

~5 MIN

Kings Park at sunset

Bushland, playgrounds and treetop walkways, with the city and the river spread out below.

~25-30 MIN BY TRAIN

Fremantle

Markets, the fishing boat harbour, heritage streets and a brewery in the afternoon.

~25 MIN

The Swan Valley

Cellar doors, breweries, chocolate and berry farms: an easy Sunday afternoon.

30-40 MIN

Perth Hills

Bushwalks, winter waterfalls around Kalamunda and Mundaring, and country cafés.



Quokkas on Rottnest Island, half an hour by ferry from Fremantle



Wildflower season: people plan whole road trips around it



Calm water days: paddleboarding is a favourite family weekend

Ten weekends to start with

- ✓ Rottnest by ferry, bikes hired, a beach to yourself.
- ✓ Fremantle markets, fish and chips at the harbour, a brewery after.
- ✓ The Swan Valley on a Sunday.
- ✓ The Pinnacles at dusk, around two hours north.
- ✓ A hills walk to a winter waterfall.
- ✓ Margaret River: cellar doors, a surf beach and the karri forest.
- ✓ Snorkelling at Mettams Pool, then breakfast at Trigg.
- ✓ Kings Park at sunset, with the city and the river below.
- ✓ Wildflower season, from late winter into spring.
- ✓ Sculpture by the Sea at Cottlesloe, then a sundowner on the sand.



Evening surf: the light is long and golden all summer



A long lunch at a cellar door, an easy Sunday from the city

Around Perth

Perth is famous for its isolation, yet its weekends reach a long way: south to the wineries and forests of the South West, north to desert spires and reef, and east into the hills.

Three hours south is the region that makes Western Australians so proud of their state: Margaret River, with world-class wine, surf breaks along a limestone coast, tall karri forest, caves and a food culture to match. On the way, Busselton's jetty runs nearly two kilometres out over turquoise water, and Bunbury, the main city of the South West, sits on a beautiful bay where dolphins visit. Closer still, Mandurah, under an hour south by train or car, is a waterside city of canals, estuaries and pelicans.

North of the city, the Coral Coast begins. The Pinnacles, thousands of limestone spires in yellow sand, are about two hours away; beyond lie Kalbarri, Hutt Lagoon's pink waters and, for a longer holiday, Ningaloo Reef, where you can swim from the beach onto coral. And when you want snow, the ski fields are a flight east: around four hours to Melbourne, then a drive into the Victorian Alps, which many families happily make an annual winter adventure.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Cottesloe Beach (nearest beach)	15–20 min	White sand, clear water and a sunset over the ocean; dozens more beaches line the coast north and south.
Victorian Alps ski fields (nearest snow)	~4 hr flight + ~3–4 hr drive	The nearest ski fields are a flight east to Melbourne, then into the mountains: a lovely winter holiday rather than a day trip.
Mandurah (nearest other city)	~50 min	Canals, estuary cruises, crabbing and pelicans, by train or by car.
Perth Airport	~20 min	Domestic flights across Australia and direct international flights to Asia, the Middle East and Europe.
Rottnest Island	~30 min ferry	Car-free island of bays, bikes and quokkas, from Fremantle.
Swan Valley	~25 min	WA's oldest wine region, with cellar doors, breweries and farm produce.
Margaret River	~3 hrs	Wineries, surf, karri forest and caves: the classic long weekend.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
The Pinnacles (Nambung National Park)	~2 hrs	Thousands of limestone spires in the desert, magical at dusk.
~50 MIN · SOUTH Mandurah Waterside living on the Peel Inlet: dolphin cruises, crabbing in season and canal-side cafés.		~2.5–3 HRS · SOUTH WEST Margaret River & Busselton Wine, surf and forest, plus the famous Busselton jetty and its underwater observatory.
~2 HRS · SOUTH WEST Bunbury A friendly coastal city with a dolphin discovery centre, beaches and a lively waterfront.		~2 HRS · NORTH The Pinnacles A desert of limestone spires near the fishing town of Cervantes; go at sunset.
30–40 MIN · EAST Perth Hills & Mundaring Bushwalks, waterfalls in winter, orchards and the start of the Bibbulmun Track.		A LONGER HOLIDAY The Coral Coast Kalbarri's gorges, pink Hutt Lagoon and Ningaloo Reef, where whale sharks visit in season.



The Busselton jetty, on the way to Margaret River, about two and a half hours south



Canal-side living in Mandurah, under an hour south of Perth



Pelicans on the shore at Mandurah, a waterside city famous for its birdlife



Bunbury's Marlston waterfront, the main city of the South West, about two hours south



Hutt Lagoon near Kalbarri, a highlight of a Coral Coast road trip



Wine country is never far: the Swan Valley is twenty-five minutes away, Margaret River three hours



Busselton Jetty, about two and a half hours south



Shared paths for cycling and running



London Court, a little Tudor-style lane in the city centre



Weekend brunch

Families and schools in Perth

Perth is a wonderful place to grow up: beaches, parks and sport everywhere, short commutes that leave time for family, and a school system used to welcoming children from overseas.



After the bell: school days here end early enough for the beach



A shaded suburban playground in Bunbury, south of Perth: parks like this are everywhere in WA

Western Australian schooling starts with Kindergarten, a part-time, non-compulsory year for four-year-olds, often at the local primary school. Pre-primary, the year children turn five to six, is the first compulsory year. Primary school runs from Year 1 to Year 6 and secondary school from Year 7 to Year 12, ending with the WA Certificate of Education (WACE) and, for university entry, an ATAR.

There are three sectors. Public schools are run by the WA Department of Education; Catholic schools by Catholic Education Western Australia; and independent schools, many of them faith-based, are represented by the Association of Independent Schools of WA. Public schools enrol by local-intake area, so your home address decides your guaranteed local school. Catholic and independent schools set their own enrolment and fees.

WA also offers specialist and selective programmes, including Perth Modern School, the state's fully academically selective public secondary school, and gifted and talented programmes in a number of public high schools.

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School fees on a temporary visa

Western Australia charges dependants of many temporary visa holders a fee to attend public schools. For the common skilled work visas this is a yearly fee charged per family rather than per child, and it is administered on behalf of the WA Department of Education by TAFE International WA. Check the current rules for your visa on the WA Department of Education's page on children who are dependants of visa holders before you plan your budget, and ask your employer whether they help with it.

Choosing a school

- ☐ Check the local-intake area at the exact address before you sign a lease, using the Department of Education's Schools Online finder.
- ☐ Look at a school's results and profile on the My School website, and visit or ask for a video call.
- ☐ Ask about English as an Additional Language or Dialect (EAL/D) support for children new to Australia.
- ☐ Uniforms are usually bought from the school's own uniform shop, often run by the parents' association, which also sells good second-hand items.
- ☐ The school year runs from early February to mid-December in four terms.

What children tend to love here

- ☒ Beach days, surf-lifesaving 'Nippers' and swimming lessons from an early age.
- ☒ The Perth Zoo across the river in South Perth, and the Aquarium of Western Australia at Hillarys.
- ☒ Riding bikes on the river and coastal paths.
- ☒ Kings Park's playgrounds, treetop walkway and bushland trails.
- ☒ Scitech, the city's hands-on science centre.
- ☒ Club sport for every age: Aussie rules, soccer, netball, cricket, basketball and more.

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Early childhood

Before Kindergarten there are long day care centres, family day care and playgroups across the city. The Australian Government's Child Care Subsidy can reduce fees, but eligibility depends on your visa, so check with Services Australia before you plan your budget.



Kindergarten in WA is usually part-time and often based at the local primary school



Outdoor childhoods: kayaking, swimming and sailing on calm river water

CRAWLEY · ON THE RIVER

The University of Western Australia

The state's oldest university, a research-intensive campus beside the Swan, with medicine and health sciences.

BENTLEY

Curtin University

WA's largest university, strong in health sciences, nursing, imaging and allied health.

MURDOCH · JOONDALUP

Murdoch & Edith Cowan

Two further public universities with nursing, health and education programmes.

FREMANTLE

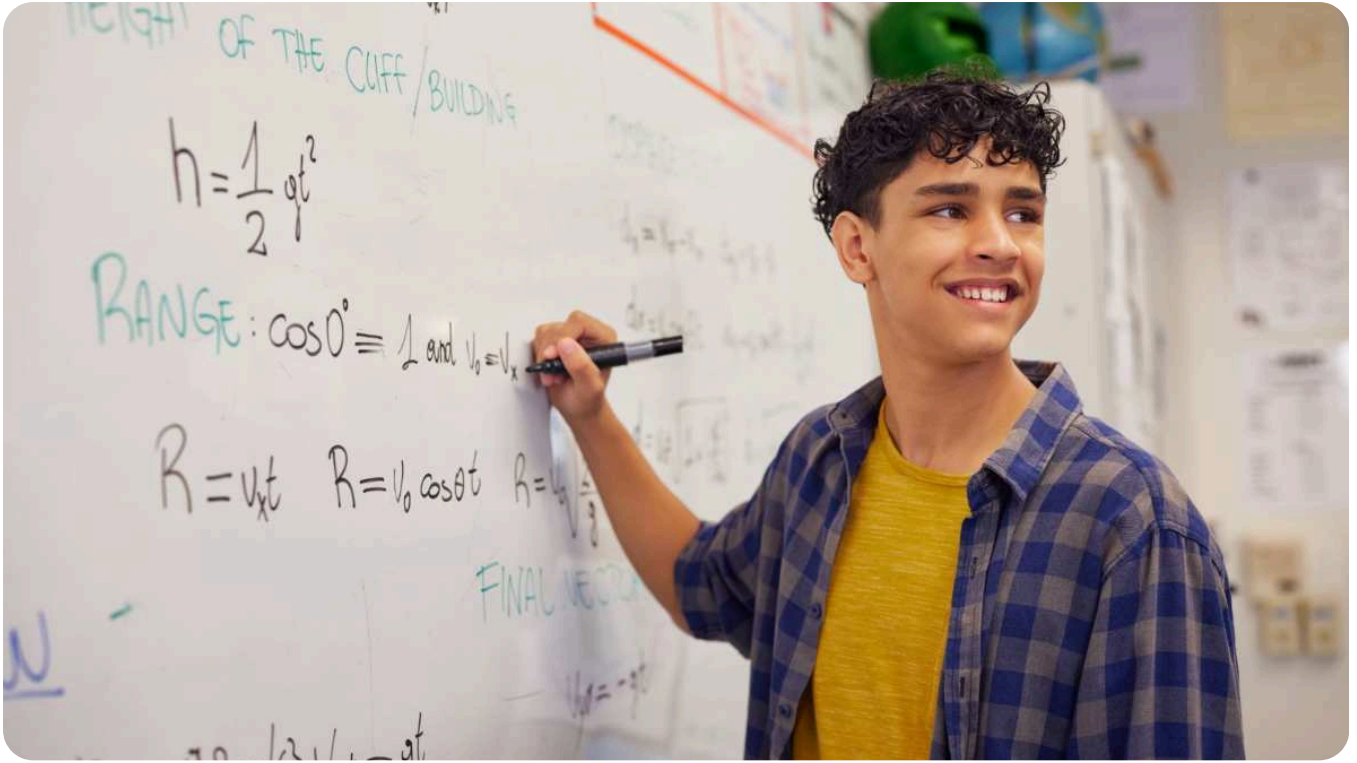
The University of Notre Dame Australia

A Catholic university in Fremantle's heritage West End, with medicine and nursing.

NORTH & SOUTH METROPOLITAN

TAFE

Vocational training and apprenticeships, and free English through the Adult Migrant English Program for eligible migrants.



Senior school: clear pathways to university and vocational training



Early learning is play-based, creative and full of colour



Outdoor play is central to early learning here

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Perth gives you the sunset, the sea breeze and the time to enjoy them.

Your Perth address book

Perth is one of Australia's most international cities, with around a third of residents born overseas. Its Malayali community is long established, with Kairali dating back to 1995 and the Malayali Association of Perth running Onam and Vishu celebrations each year, and there are Syro-Malabar, Syro-Malankara and Indian Orthodox congregations alongside active Nigerian, Filipino and Irish communities, temples, gurdwaras and mosques across the city.

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City of Perth

The city centre council: events, parking, libraries and services for central Perth

perth.wa.gov.au

City of Fremantle

Fremantle's council: bins, libraries, parking, events and community services

fremantle.wa.gov.au

City of Joondalup

Council for the northern coastal suburbs, with a useful online community directory

joondalup.wa.gov.au

Transperth

Trains, buses and ferries, SmartRider and the journey planner

transperth.wa.gov.au

healthdirect

Free 24-hour health advice from a registered nurse, anywhere in Australia

1800 022 222 healthdirect.gov.au

Office of Multicultural Interests

WA Government office for multicultural communities, with a services directory and community events calendar

omi.wa.gov.au

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Malayali Association of Perth (MAP)

Not-for-profit Malayali association founded in 2007: Onam and Vishu celebrations, cultural nights, youth meet-ups, sports tournaments and support for newly arrived families.

mapconnect.org.au

Kairali (Perth Malayali Cultural Club)

Perth's oldest Malayali club, formed in 1995: Kerala arts and cultural events and informal 'Kairali Nites' social evenings.

kairali.org.au

Nigerian Association of Western Australia (NAWA)

Community association for Nigerians in WA, with events, dinners and an annual food and cultural festival.

nawa.com.au

Filipino Australian Club of Perth

Long-running Filipino community club that hosts the Grand Filipino Fiesta and other community events; find event listings on the Office of Multicultural Interests calendar.

Irish Club of WA

Irish cultural and social club in Subiaco since 1950: live music, sport on the screens, food and a warm welcome for all nationalities.

08 9381 5213 irishclubofwa.com.au

Ethnic Communities Council of WA (ECCWA)

The state's peak multicultural umbrella body, advocating for culturally diverse communities and running citizenship and community programmes.

eccwa.org.au

Office of Multicultural Interests (WA Government)

Services directory and a community events calendar covering festivals and associations across Perth.

omi.wa.gov.au

Metropolitan Migrant Resource Centre (MMRC)

Settlement support for migrants across the Perth metro area, based in Mirrabooka: case management, advocacy, counselling, youth and family programmes.

08 9345 5755 mmrcwa.org.au

Adult Migrant English Program (AMEP) at North Metropolitan TAFE

Free English classes for eligible migrants, including a city campus on Aberdeen Street, Northbridge. Register within six months of your visa start date or arrival.

08 9427 1377 northmetrotafe.wa.edu.au

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St Mary's Cathedral (Catholic)

Perth's Catholic cathedral on Victoria Square in the city centre.

08 9223 1350 saintmarys.au

St Joseph Syro-Malabar Parish, Perth

Syro-Malabar Catholic parish with Malayalam Qurbana at several centres across the city, including Orange Grove, Joondalup, Embleton, Bull Creek and Parmelia.

syromalabarperth.org.au

Syro-Malankara Catholic community, Maida Vale

Syro-Malankara Catholic Sunday services at St Francis of Assisi Parish, 6 Lilian Road, Maida Vale.

syromalankara.church

St George Indian Orthodox Church, Perth

Malankara (Indian) Orthodox parish founded by Malayali families in 2009, with services in Malayalam and English.

sgiocperth.org.au

St George's Cathedral (Anglican)

Perth's Anglican cathedral in the city centre, with daily services, choral evensong and concerts.

perthcathedral.org

Riverview Church

One of WA's largest churches, with Pentecostal roots and a contemporary style, at 1 Thorogood Street, Burswood.

riverview.church

Perth Mosque

WA's oldest mosque, at 427–429 William Street, Perth (Northbridge), with daily and Friday prayers.

Perth Hindu Temple

Hindu temple and community centre at 271 Warton Road, Canning Vale; open daily mornings and evenings.

08 9455 2097 hindu.org.au

Perth Bala Murugan Temple

South Indian (Tamil) style Saivite temple at Mandogalup, south of the city, with daily pooja.

perthmurugan.org.au

Sikh Association of WA Gurdwara

Gurdwara in Canning Vale (off Nicholson Road) with Sunday prayers and langar, the shared community meal.

Buddhist Society of Western Australia

Meditation classes, Dhamma talks and retreats, including the Dhammaloka centre and city meditation groups.

bswa.org

Perth Hebrew Congregation

Modern Orthodox synagogue in Menora, serving the Perth Jewish community since the 1890s.

thephc.com.au

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Northbridge, Cannington, Morley, Mirrabooka & Willetton

The suburbs with the widest choice of Asian supermarkets, Indian grocers, halal butchers and African and South African stores. A Saturday wander is the easiest way to find your favourites.

Halal meat: ask at the mosque

Perth Mosque on William Street and local Muslim communities can point you to current halal-certified butchers near you.

Kosher food: ask the congregation

The Perth Hebrew Congregation in Menora can advise on kosher food and suppliers in Perth.

thephc.com.au

Woolworths

National supermarket chain with stores across Perth; online delivery and click-and-collect.

woolworths.com.au

Coles

National supermarket chain with stores across Perth; online delivery and click-and-collect.

coles.com.au

ALDI

Discount supermarket with stores across the metro area, good for a lower-cost weekly basket.

aldi.com.au

IGA

Independent local supermarkets in many suburbs.

iga.com.au

Farmer Jack's

Perth-based supermarket chain with a dozen stores, focused on fresh WA produce, seafood and meat.

farmerjacks.com.au

Fremantle Markets

Historic market hall and yard at 74 South Terrace, Fremantle, open Friday to Sunday and public holiday Mondays: produce, street food, makers and buskers.

fremantlemarkets.com.au

Wanneroo Markets

Large weekend market in Wangara, northern suburbs, open Friday to Sunday, with variety stalls and a big food court.

wanneroomarkets.com.au

Schools Online (WA Department of Education)

Find a public school and check its local-intake area for an exact address.

det.wa.edu.au/schoolsonline

Fees for dependants of temporary visa holders

WA Department of Education information on public school fees for children of temporary visa holders, administered by TAFE International WA.

tafeinternational.wa.edu.au/wa-government-schools/children-who-are-dependants-visa-holders

Catholic Education Western Australia

Runs around 160 Catholic schools across WA; enrolment information and school finder.

cewa.edu.au

Association of Independent Schools of WA (AISWA)

Peak body for WA's independent schools, with a school finder by region and religious affiliation.

ais.wa.edu.au

My School

National website with profiles and results for every Australian school.

myschool.edu.au

School uniforms

Most WA schools sell their uniforms through the school's own uniform shop, often run by the parents' association (P&C), which usually also sells second-hand items. Ask the school office for opening times.

realestate.com.au

Australia's largest rental and sales listings site.

realestate.com.au

Domain

Rental and sales listings, with suburb profiles.

domain.com.au

Flatmates.com.au

Rooms and shared houses, useful for the first few weeks.

flatmates.com.au

Bonds Administration (Consumer Protection WA)

Holds rental bonds in WA until the end of a tenancy; explains bond limits, lodging and releasing a bond.
consumerprotection.wa.gov.au/rental-bonds

Circle Green Community Legal

Free statewide tenancy advice for renters, plus workplace and migration legal help.
08 6148 3636 circlegreen.org.au

Department of Transport: moving to WA

How to transfer or convert an interstate or overseas driver's licence when you move to Western Australia.
transport.wa.gov.au/licensing/drivers-licence/visit-move-wa

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Transperth

Perth's trains, buses and ferries, with the journey planner, timetables and SmartRider information.
transperth.wa.gov.au

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Numbeo: Perth

Crowd-sourced prices to compare Perth with your current city.
numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Perth

Expatistan: Perth

A second crowd-sourced comparison, including a family estimate; worth running alongside Numbeo.
expatistan.com/cost-of-living/perth



Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in Australia you land.

000 112 healthdirect 13 11 14 13 11 26 1800 882 436

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time
000

Emergency from a mobile

Also connects to emergency services from any mobile phone
112

healthdirect

Free 24/7 health advice from a registered nurse
1800 022 222 [healthdirect.gov.au](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au)

Lifeline

24/7 crisis support and suicide prevention, by phone, text or chat
13 11 14 [lifeline.org.au](https://www.lifeline.org.au)

Poisons Information Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned
13 11 26

Pregnancy, Birth and Baby

Free support for parents from pregnancy to preschool
1800 882 436 [pregnancybirthbaby.org.au](https://www.pregnancybirthbaby.org.au)

Private health insurance complaints

The Commonwealth Ombudsman's free complaints service
1300 737 299 [ombudsman.gov.au](https://www.ombudsman.gov.au)

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Department of Home Affairs

Visas, skilled occupation lists and processing times
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au

ImmiAccount

Lodge and track your visa application online
online.immi.gov.au

Register of migration agents (OMARA)

Check an agent is registered before you pay
mara.gov.au

Ahpra

National registration and the National Boards
1300 419 495 [ahpra.gov.au](https://www.ahpra.gov.au)

Fair Work Ombudsman

Awards, pay rates and your rights at work
13 13 94 [fairwork.gov.au](https://www.fairwork.gov.au)

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Medicare · Services Australia

Enrolment, cards, claims and reciprocal health care agreements
132 011 [servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare](https://www.servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare)

healthdirect service finder

Find a GP, pharmacy, urgent care or hospital near you
[healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services)

privatehealth.gov.au

Compare private health cover independently; run by the Commonwealth Ombudsman
[privatehealth.gov.au](https://www.privatehealth.gov.au)

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NSW school finder

Government schools and catchments in New South Wales
[education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder](https://www.education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder)

Find my school (Victoria)

School zones for any Victorian address
[findmyschool.vic.gov.au](https://www.findmyschool.vic.gov.au)

Find a school (Queensland)

State schools and catchment areas
qld.gov.au/education/schools/find

Find a public school (WA)

Western Australian public schools and local-intake areas
wa.gov.au/service/education-and-training/school-education/find-public-school

School zones (South Australia)

Zone maps for government schools
education.sa.gov.au/parents-and-families/enrol-school-or-preschool/zones-catchments-and-capacity-management/maps-school-zones-enrolment-year

Find your local school (Tasmania)

Intake areas for Tasmanian government schools
decyp.tas.gov.au/learning/find-your-local-school

Priority enrolment areas (ACT)

Find a Canberra public school for your address
act.gov.au/education-and-training/find-a-school-and-enrol

Choose a school (NT)

Urban and remote schools in the Northern Territory
nt.gov.au/learning/primary-and-secondary-students/choose-a-school

Starting Blocks

Compare childcare services and quality ratings near you
startingblocks.gov.au

Child Care Subsidy

Eligibility, rates and how to apply
servicesaustralia.gov.au/child-care-subsidy

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Australian Taxation Office

Apply for your tax file number (TFN), tax and super
13 28 61 ato.gov.au

Moneysmart

Free, independent budgeting, super and banking tools
moneysmart.gov.au

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TIS National

Free interpreting by phone, 24/7, in 150+ languages
131 450 tisnational.gov.au

Settle in Australia

Home Affairs' settlement topics and services for new arrivals
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/settling-in-australia

MyAus app

Government app to help newcomers find services, in many languages
myausapp.com

Overseas drivers (Austroads)

How overseas licences are recognised, with links to each state's licensing authority
austroads.gov.au/drivers-and-vehicles/overseas-drivers/country-recognition



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not registered migration agents.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to Ahpra registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

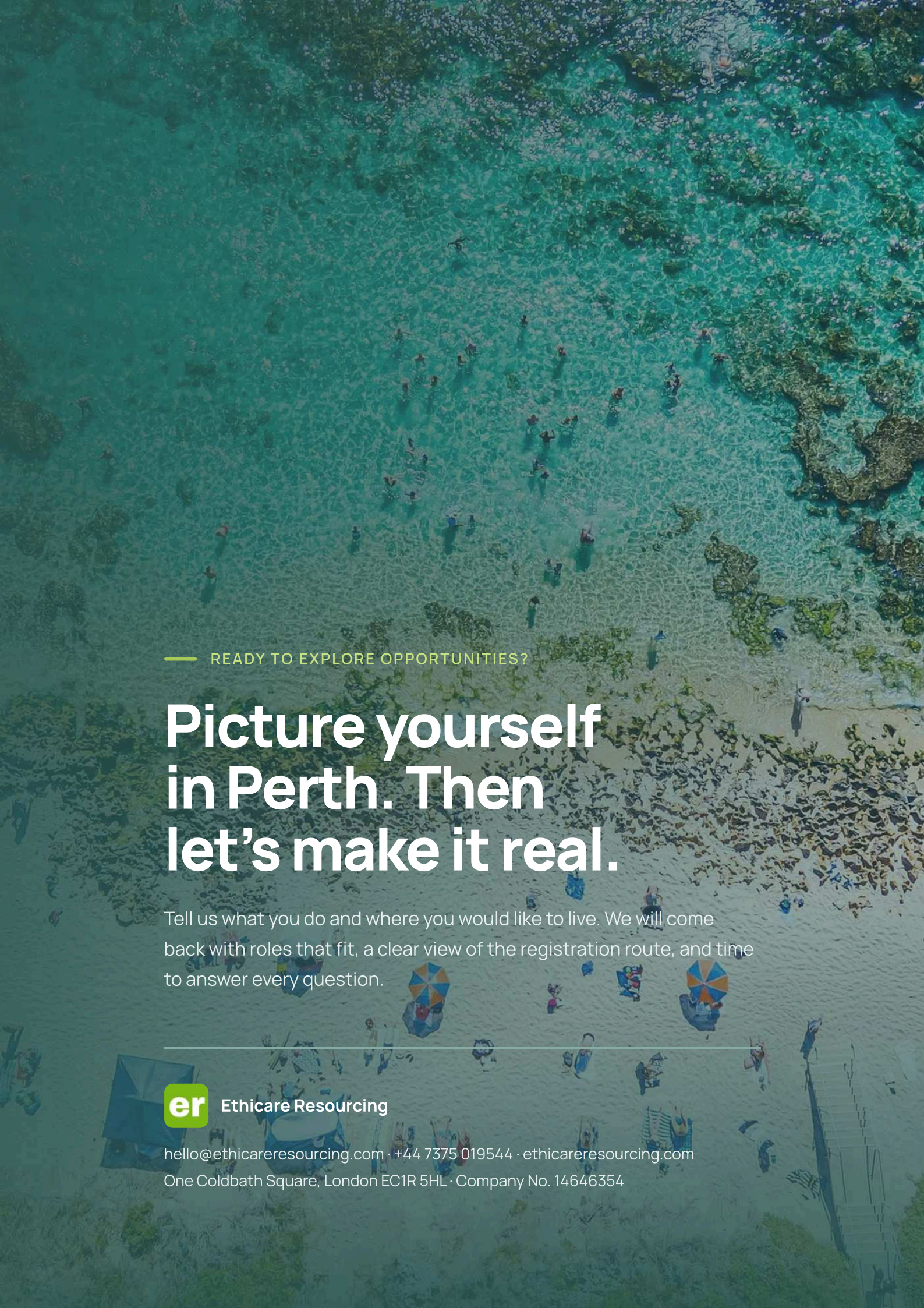
Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Perth. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, a clear view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

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